

World in Brief: Iran's warning to Israel; SpaceX's value jumps



Photograph: NurPhoto via Getty Images

Iran's foreign minister said the war with **America** would not “fully come to an end” until **Israel** withdraws its troops from southern **Lebanon**. Iran's armed forces warned Israel of a “hard response” if attacks continued, according to state media. Earlier Donald Trump said Binyamin Netanyahu, Israel's prime minister, should be “more responsible”. Iran and America are due to formalise [their peace deal](#) on Friday.

SpaceX became the world's fifth-most valuable company, passing Amazon (and briefly Microsoft) during its third day of trading since its [record initial public offering](#). Shares in the rocketry and artificial-intelligence firm closed 4.8% higher on Tuesday. Meanwhile, SpaceX agreed to buy Anysphere, which makes Cursor, a popular tool for writing code using AI, for \$60bn.

Volodymyr Zelensky, **Ukraine's** president, met Mr Trump at the G7 summit in France. The American president later said that “Russia should make a deal” noting, that both sides had many [casualties in the war](#). European leaders have urged Mr Trump to host peace talks. Earlier G7 leaders agreed to tighten sanctions on Russia's energy exports.

A **Russian warship** reportedly fired warning shots near a yacht in the **English Channel**, albeit outside Britain's territorial waters. Britain's defence ministry is investigating the incident, in which no one was hurt. On Sunday Britain's armed forces seized an oil tanker suspected of being part of Russia's "[shadow fleet](#)" in the Channel for the first time.

The **European Parliament** approved a [trade deal with America](#), which the bloc's executive struck with the Trump administration [last July](#). Europe will cut tariffs on American industrial goods and some agricultural ones. Mr Trump has threatened that if the EU did not ratify the deal by July 4th, he would retaliate with "much higher" levies.

General Motors, a carmaker, and **Lockheed Martin**, a defence company, announced a partnership to boost weapons manufacturing in America. [The Pentagon](#) facilitated the deal, they said. Lockheed's chief operating officer described production capacity was a "national security capability"; the company will invest \$9bn on modernising facilities over four years. GM plans to spend \$7bn on research and development.

Snap, the parent company of the social-media platform Snapchat, started taking pre-orders for its [augmented-reality glasses](#)—priced at \$2,195 each. Snap said the spectacles, which superimpose computer imagery onto the real world, could be used for getting directions or consulting AI tools without screens. Competitors including Apple and Meta are racing to perfect wearable devices that might one day [supplant the smartphone](#).

Figure of the day: 76%, the share of Brits who backed a social-media ban for kids in a YouGov poll in March. Read about how the policy, introduced on Monday, captures the [British prime minister's vanilla populism](#).

Will America's and Iran's deal survive?



Photograph: EPA

“Let the oil flow!” was how Donald Trump announced [America's and Iran's deal](#). America's president said the preliminary agreement was “all signed” on Monday. A lot could go wrong before an official signing ceremony in Geneva on Friday. The “memorandum of understanding” has yet to be published. Its details, such as how much power Iran will hold over the Strait of Hormuz and the precise sanctions relief it will receive, could face opposition in America or Iran. Planned talks over Iran's nuclear programme may quickly fall apart.

The most immediate risk may be Lebanon, where Israel and Hizbullah, Iran's proxy, have been fighting since March. The ceasefire is supposed to put an end to that, but the terms are vague. The deal was almost scuppered hours before the announcement, when Israel launched an air strike on Beirut, the Lebanese capital, claiming it was in retaliation against Hizbullah drones. It may not survive another strike.

Russia and Turkey are out of the honeymoon phase



Photograph: Alamy

Turkey's foreign minister, Hakan Fidan, heads to Moscow on Tuesday to meet Sergey Lavrov, his Russian counterpart. Alongside trade and investment, the pair will discuss geopolitics. Mr Fidan will probably try to gauge Russia's appetite for renewed peace negotiations with Ukraine and suggest Turkey host the next round of talks.

Mr Lavrov, meanwhile, will be eager to show that Russia's relations with Turkey remain strong. His ministry has boasted of frequent phone calls between Russia's dictator, Vladimir Putin, and Recep Tayyip Erdogan, Turkey's president.

But there is [increasing evidence](#) that Turkey is cooling on Russia. In 2017, it purchased a pricey Russian missile system; in response, America slapped Turkey with sanctions. Similar deals seem inconceivable today. Turkey is also keen to capitalise on Russia's dwindling influence elsewhere. It has recently been making overtures to Armenia, where the Western-leaning prime minister just won a parliamentary majority. No amount of phone calls can disguise that.

Japan raises rates again



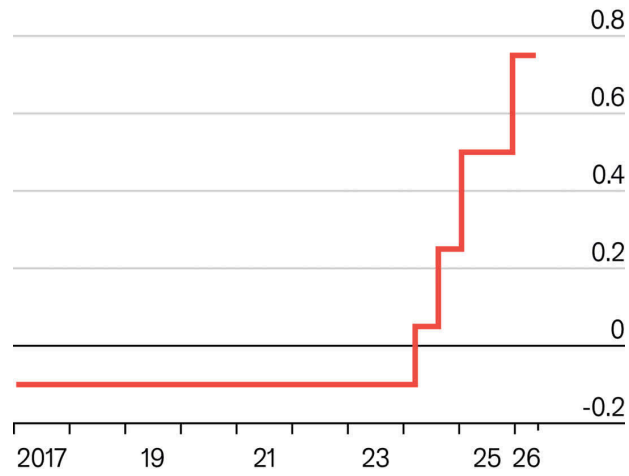
Photograph: Reuters

When Ueda Kazuo agreed to become the Bank of Japan's governor in 2023, he took on one of the world's [hardest monetary-policy assignments](#): undoing years of stimulus, including long periods of negative interest rates. Last week Mr Ueda was taken to hospital with an infected liver cyst. As a result, he missed the bank's rate-setting meeting on Tuesday. Instead a deputy announced the BoJ's most consequential decision in a long while: to raise interest rates from 0.75% to 1%, their highest level in three decades.

The bank also set out its plans for its vast stockpile of Japanese government bonds. During its fight against deflation, the BoJ bought huge amounts, as [public debt](#) ballooned. Since 2024, the bank has slowed its bond purchases and allowed existing ones to mature. That has helped push up long-term bond yields, which recently reached their highest levels in decades. The bank signalled a slower reduction in bond purchases.

Bigger in Japan

Japan, central-bank benchmark interest rate, %



Source: Bank of Japan

The sanctification of J.D. Vance



Photograph: AP

J.D. Vance, America's vice-president, loves a bit of St Augustine. In a 2020 essay that was a little about why he became a Catholic, and a little about why America is going to the dogs, he quoted the fourth-century saint at length. Augustine felt ancient Rome was sinful: it ate, it drank, it debauched. To Mr Vance, this criticism was true of our “modern age”, as well.

Now he is echoing Augustine in form: the saint wrote an autobiography of conversion (arguably the first autobiography ever) in his “Confessions”. On Tuesday, Mr Vance publishes his own conversion memoir, “Communion”. The books could be similar in content, too: both men had odd mother-figures (Augustine's struggled with alcohol; Mr Vance's grandmother, who [raised him](#), poured petrol on his grandfather then set him alight). And both men seem to specialise in deferred holiness. Mr Vance preaches duty, virtue and abstemiousness—yet works for Donald Trump. Perhaps he is inspired by Augustine's most famous prayer: for God to make him chaste, “but not yet”.

Daily Quiz



Illustration: Sandra Navarro

We will serve you a new question each weekday. On Friday your challenge is to give us all five answers and tell us the theme. Email your responses (and your home city and country) by 1700 BST on Friday to [\[email protected\]](#). We'll pick three winners at random and crown them on Saturday.

Tuesday: What title is given to the chief adviser to a ruler in the Game of Thrones series?

Monday: *La vache qui rit* is a French cheese brand featuring which animal?

*Humour is the truth; wit is an
exaggeration of the truth.*

Stan Laurel